

Freelance Client Machine: Money, Scope & Hard Conversations

Tested AI prompt pack — Word + PDF

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The hardest conversations in freelancing are the most profitable to get right. These prompts help you stay firm and professional - no passive-aggression, no caving.

Prompt count: 10 · Category: freelance · Price: GH¢ 85

Scope-creep response

WHEN TO USE

Client asks for work outside the agreed scope.

THE PROMPT

Write a reply to [CLIENT] who asked for [EXTRA WORK] that falls outside our agreement covering [ORIGINAL SCOPE]. Acknowledge the request, explain it's outside the agreed scope, and offer to do it as a paid addition at GH¢ [AMOUNT] (or X hours at my rate). Give them a simple yes/no choice. Tone: helpful, not apologetic, no guilt-tripping. Under 120 words.

CUSTOMIZE

Price the addition immediately - never say 'let me see'.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

A reply that makes extra work a business decision, not a favour.

Invoice chase - first reminder

WHEN TO USE

Invoice is 1-2 days late.

THE PROMPT

Write a friendly first reminder for invoice [#NUMBER] of GH¢ [AMOUNT] for [PROJECT], due [DATE]. Assume it's an oversight, not malice. Two sentences: one referencing the invoice, one asking if they need anything to process it. Add the payment details again. Tone: light, zero accusation.

CUSTOMIZE

Send within 48 hours of the due date - politeness has a window.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

A nudge that gets most invoices paid within a day.

Invoice chase - firm final notice

WHEN TO USE

Invoice is 2+ weeks late after a friendly reminder.

THE PROMPT

Write a firm final invoice notice for [#NUMBER] of GH¢ [AMOUNT], [X] days overdue. State: (1) the facts - invoice number, date, amount, reminders sent, (2) a deadline of [DATE] for payment, (3) the consequence if not paid by then: work pauses and late fee of [X]% applies. Tone: professional, calm, final. Under 150 words.

CUSTOMIZE

Only send this if you're truly willing to pause work.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

A notice that says 'I take my money seriously' without shouting.

Rate negotiation - the 'too expensive' reply

WHEN TO USE

Prospect says your rate is too high.

THE PROMPT

Write a response to a prospect who says my rate of GH¢ [AMOUNT] is too expensive. Do NOT lower the rate. Instead: (1) reframe the value with one specific result I've delivered [RESULT], (2) offer an alternative scope reduction if budget is the issue, (3) ask what their budget is. Tone: confident, not defensive, not apologetic.

CUSTOMIZE

Use a real past result with numbers if you have one.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

A reply that holds your rate while keeping the conversation open.

The silent client - mid-project ghost

WHEN TO USE

Client stops replying mid-project.

THE PROMPT

Write a follow-up to [CLIENT] who has been silent for [X] days on [PROJECT]. I need [FEEDBACK/APPROVAL/FINAL PAYMENT] to proceed. State clearly: if I don't hear back by [DATE] I will [PAUSE THE PROJECT / consider the current deliverable final and invoice]. Tone: firm and professional, not emotional.

CUSTOMIZE

Pick a consequence you'll actually follow through on.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

A message that ends the silence or ends the limbo.

Asking for a deposit upfront

WHEN TO USE

New client, no history, first project.

THE PROMPT

Write a short message to [CLIENT] confirming we're ready to start [PROJECT] and explaining I require a [X]% deposit (GH¢ [AMOUNT]) before kickoff, with the balance due on delivery. Keep it light and standard - frame it as 'how I work with all new clients'. One line on why (booking the time). Under 80 words.

CUSTOMIZE

Never waive the deposit for brand-new clients.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

A request that normalizes deposits instead of apologizing for them.

Late project apology + revised date

WHEN TO USE

You're going to miss a deadline.

THE PROMPT

Write an apology to [CLIENT] for the delay on [PROJECT]. Be specific: what happened in one honest sentence (no novel-length excuses), what's done, when they'll get the rest [NEW DATE], and one small concession (e.g. an extra revision round free). Tone: accountable, brief, no over-apologizing. Under 120 words.

CUSTOMIZE

Announce the delay BEFORE the deadline, not after.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

An apology that keeps trust because it comes with a plan.

Handling a rude or unreasonable client

WHEN TO USE

Client is abusive or demands impossible things.

THE PROMPT

Write a calm reply to [CLIENT] who sent [THE UNREASONABLE MESSAGE - quote briefly]. Structure: (1) acknowledge the frustration, (2) restate what I CAN do and by when, (3) set one clear boundary on communication (e.g. 'I respond to messages within 24 hours, Mon-Fri'), (4) offer to part ways professionally if that's not acceptable. Tone: ice-cold professional, zero drama.

CUSTOMIZE

If it's truly abusive, skip to step 4.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

A reply that protects your peace and your reputation.

Pricing your package (rate calculator prompt)

WHEN TO USE

You don't know what to charge for a new service.

THE PROMPT

Help me price a freelance [SERVICE] package. Costs: monthly expenses GH¢ [AMOUNT], taxes ~[X]%, desired monthly income GH¢ [AMOUNT]. Time per project: [X] hours. Walk me through: (1) hourly rate needed, (2) a 3-tier package (basic/standard/premium) with what each includes, (3) what GH¢ prices to put on each tier, (4) the psychology of the middle tier as the anchor.

CUSTOMIZE

Use real numbers - the output is only as good as the inputs.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

A pricing structure you can defend in your head.

Ending a project early (client side)

WHEN TO USE

You need to fire a client.

THE PROMPT

Write a professional message to end our working relationship after [PROJECT/PERIOD]. Structure: (1) thank them for the work together, (2) explain I'm restructuring my client load (no need for detail), (3) commit to finishing [CURRENT DELIVERABLE] or hand over files by [DATE], (4) wish them well. Tone: grateful, final, no drama. Under 100 words.

CUSTOMIZE

Give 2-4 weeks of runway if you can.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

A clean exit that leaves the door politely closed.